

Announcements for April 20/ May 3 2020

<http://www.orthodox.net/announcements/announcements-2020-05-03.html>

<http://www.orthodox.net/announcements/announcements-2020-05-03.pdf>

<http://www.orthodox.net/announcements/announcements-2020-05-03.doc>

English/Thai:

"Christ is risen!" / "Pra - Chris - Song - Phun - Kun - Cheeb - Laow."

"Truly, He is risen!" / "Song - Phun - Kun - Cheeb, - Pen - Kwam - Jing."

Audio (by a native Thai speaker): http://www.orthodox.net/music/pascha_2020+christ-is-risen-english-and-thai.mp3

St. Nicholas Orthodox Church, McKinney Texas is reopening with limited attendance.

2nd Sat of Pascha, April 19/May 2, 2020

Instructions on how to sign up for the services

<http://www.orthodox.net/announcements/announcements-2020-05-02.html>

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<http://www.orthodox.net/announcements/announcements-2020-05-02.doc>

In obedience to the directives of Archbishop Peter, we are reopening the church for a limited number of people. Vladyka has blessed us to re-open in accordance with common sense and the limitations imposed by the CDC and the State of Texas. Because of the social distancing requirement, we cannot open completely, but we are able to invite more people to attend each service, pray and receive the Holy Mysteries. Besides readers, singers, live-casters and cleaners, there will be room for 18 more people in the church. Keep reading to learn how you can sign up to attend. **It is our hope that, as much as possible, whole families will attend together.**

Beginning this coming week (starting on Wednesday, May 6th), we will have at least 3 Liturgies that you can sign up to attend: every Wednesday, Saturday, and Sunday, preceded the previous day by evening services. Please try to prioritize Wednesday, then Saturday, then Sunday when you sign up. If you are able to attend the liturgy on a day other than Sunday, out of consideration to others, please sign up for that liturgy. It may be that we can accommodate everyone in one week, or it might take two weeks. We still must be patient.

Requirements and Restrictions.

You must observe 6' distancing from everybody who does not live in the same house, and some people will be in the attached hall (with the doors propped open). Parents, please do everything you can to keep your children close.

If you have COVID-like symptoms or are in contact with somebody who does, do not attend.

If you are in an at-risk group, please do not attend.

You are not required to wear a mask but you may if that is your desire.

You should prepare for the Liturgy by attending at least some portion of the evening service on the prior day, unless this is completely impossible. If you wish to commune and cannot attend the previous evening service, you must **arrange this in advance** with the serving priest.

If you wish to receive Holy Communion, you should confess in advance and prepare as usual.

Catechumens and non-Orthodox family members are *welcome and encouraged* to sign up and attend.

Some people believe that the most important purpose of the Divine liturgy is to receive the Eucharist. This is not true. The most important purpose of the Divine liturgy is to meet God and experience Him, and become enlightened and changed. The Holy Eucharist is of course central to these things, but without our ardent prayer, we can go away after communing from the liturgy without benefit. That is why it is just as important for catechumens and non-Orthodox family members to come to the liturgy and to pray as it is for Orthodox Christians to commune at the liturgy.

We're using SignUp.com to organize our upcoming SignUps.

Here's how it works in 3 easy steps:

- 1) Click this link to see our SignUp on SignUp.com: <https://signup.com/go/GmQhOMA>
- 2) Choose a day, and press the green button, "Sign up".
- 3) Sign-up using your facebook or google account or by entering your email address. *You will NOT need to register an account or keep a password on SignUp.com*

Note: SignUp.com does not share your email address with anyone. If you prefer not to use your email address, please contact Fr Nicholas or Seraphim and we can sign you up manually.

Yours in Christ, Priest Seraphim and Priest Nicholas

Service Schedule:

Date	Time	Service	Stream? Zoom? Links/Credentials
5/5 Tue	6pm	Vespers	Maybe. It will likely be rustic. If you are signed up for liturgy on Wed, you must attend Vespers in order to commune, OR MAKE PRIOR ARRANGEMENTS with the serving priest
5/6 Wed	9am	Divine Liturgy – ST GEORGE	youtube.com/orthodoxnet/live
5/7 Thu	6pm	Moleben	Zoom. https://us02web.zoom.us/j/82621105200?pwd=TjRQSUhLVVRMUUcvc3U09
5/8 Fri	6pm	Vespers	See note for Tue Vespers
5/9 Sat	9am	Divine Liturgy	
5/9 Sat	5pm	Vigil – 4 th Sunday of Pascha	See note for Tue Vespers youtube.com/orthodoxnet/live
5/10 Sun	10am	Liturgy– 4 th Sunday of Pascha	youtube.com/orthodoxnet/live

We do a Mitey Mites collection every week. There are more challenges now, since the church is closed to the public, but we are still collecting every week for the extreme needs that are becoming more pressing every day. This week, we are collecting for

Fr. Cassian's Urgent Appeal for Funds for Famine Relief for Ugandan Youth:

I am asking for help. In the city parishes of Kampala and Jinja, children, teens, and young adults are already starting to go hungry. For \$7, you can help me and the organization of which I am the sponsor, feed one of your brothers or sisters in Christ, beginning with those most in need, as these are known and identified by the Orthodox community locally.

This program was initiated at the episcopal level in the Ugandan Orthodox Church, by Archbishop Jonah of Kampala and All Uganda, who asked the Orthodox Christian Youth Network of Uganda to prioritize, amongst its activities, the business of getting food to vulnerable Orthodox youth in Kampala and Jinja. The members of our local grassroots organization are collecting food and money from its local members, and encouraging vigorous local agricultural production amongst its rural members. Storage facilities have been obtained, and a team of youth workers to create and deliver bags of food has been organized.

The initial goal of this program is to provide food relief to 500 needy youths (and through them, in some cases, to their families) - focusing on those who are sick, in immediate need, without families, or who are living hand to mouth and have been deprived of day labor opportunities or meals at their local schools during the Covid-19 shutdown ordered by the Ugandan government. A serious effort has been made to provide maximal nutrition at minimal cost. At the current time, the goal is for each emergency food package to include 5 kg. of maize flour, 1 kg. of beans, and salt (which can be supplemented with widely available greens, leaf vegetables and fruit). The cost of each care package, which should feed an individual youth for 12 to 20 days is \$7.00. This includes the actual costs of the foodstuffs, bought in bulk, and some \$.35 cents in transportation costs and overhead.

Can you help? I am at the end of my own personal resources, and there is a limit to the degree that I can expect my own parish to underwrite my own concerns for the youth of Africa. They have been very generous, and will doubtless be more so in the weeks and months to come. But the need is now, and those in the urban ghettos of Uganda who are already experiencing a nutritional deficit at the beginning of this crisis are going to be in desperate straits long before this emergency comes to an end. Getting food to them now may mean the difference between survival and starvation before the end of summer.

It is a hard time for all of us. Our own nation has lost over 60,000 souls in two months, and economies the world over are failing. It is not a good time to ask for money, God knows, and many of you are struggling with bills and wondering how you will take care of yourself. I am, of course, not appealing to those of you in such circumstances for anything but prayer. But if you have been blessed, still have a job, still have a home, and still have

your health - might you be willing to help save some souls who are most unlikely to be remembered by anyone else in this difficult time. You may be all the light there is in a very dark place.

We have set up a [PayPal link](#) which allows you to donate to our Mitey Mites Cause of the week. Any money collected through this link in the next 6 days will be applied to this week's collection.

If the link above doesn't work, you can enter this URL: https://www.paypal.com/cgi-bin/webscr?cmd=_s-xclick&hosted_button_id=FHWE4PALUPG7U&source=url

If you've read this far, want to tell you that Fr Cassian is one of the good ones. I've known him for a long time and he is a good friend, and love to spar with him about politics. I went to Uganda with him in December last year. I may know some of the people that are getting fed. We have lots of other stuff to do and lots of other people to help, but this is an absolutely worthy cause. Next week, I plan to collect for a local Orthodox Christian, Kirk, who is suffering from cancer and has huge bills. We will continue to collect for our family which is encountering huge bills. Times are difficult, but if we do not give alms out of our substance, it will be worse for those that we could have helped and for us.

Standing Announcements in reserve:

Welcome to our guests! Please fill out a guest card at the candle table in the back of the church. We'd also love to give you a complimentary St. Nicholas coffee mug and encourage you to fill it with coffee and get to know us at our complimentary lunch after the post-communion prayers. During Trapeza, we would ask that all children seven years old or younger be accompanied through the line by a parent or older sibling.

We have many 2020 calendars left. Please take one from the candle table - they are very helpful for keeping track of scripture readings, saints of the day and fasting rules. Please also leave a donation to cover the cost of purchasing the calendars.

Our Choir rehearses each Sunday morning at 9:15 AM. If you are interested in joining, please speak to Matushka Jenny Park.

On the First (usually) Friday of each month we will have our Friday Fellowship gatherings. The theme for the next few months will be the family as a "small church".

Our Sisterhood helps with many things around the church, from cleaning to our weekly Trapeza. If you would like to join, please speak to Matushka Marina.

Our newly revitalized brotherhood helps with work around the property. If you are interested in getting involved, please contact Rdr. Sergius Burns.

Update on the hall renovations: ...

Saved for later:

“Did you know?” Q&A series: --

Question:

Do you have a question you'd like answered? Send it to Fr. Nicholas to add to our list.

“Did you know?” series (short answers):

- How do I pray with children?
- How often should I pray? Should I pray with my family or by myself?
- How do I pray with children? How do I teach them to pray?
- How often should I confess?
- How often should I commune?
- Illness and caring for loved ones.
- How to prepare for death.
- How to help your loved one prepare for death.

We would like to remind everybody that the church needs your financial support.

- If you have not filled out a 2020 membership/stewardship form and you consider St. Nicholas your primary church, PLEASE do so today. Even the very small pledges add up quickly and enable us to budget with more confidence.
- Also, we would ask everybody to fill out a pledge form for our new building fundraising effort. This will help us to meet the bills related to our renovation efforts and maintenance of the new building in the short term, and hopefully start paying down the note pretty soon. Again, even small pledges will add up - but please do more if you can!

We will roll out an external fundraising campaign for the building in March - stay tuned!

Many Years:

Eternal Memory: